



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Valor Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.valorclassicalacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Valor Classical Academy (Noblesville, IN, 46061) presents a clearly classical orientation in its public materials. The program foregrounds liberal-arts formation, virtue and civic virtue, engagement with Great Books, and a Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy. The school explicitly aligns with a Hillsdale College K-12 curriculum framework, emphasizes teacher-led instruction, and promotes a culture of moral character, decorum, and critical thinking. Based on the six-element rubric, Valor is overall CLASSICAL, with especially strong alignment in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Parent/Community engagement. Categories with somewhat lesser explicit alignment—Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and some aspects of Faculty—still show classical signals, but without strong expressions of theology or liturgical practice or a fully articulated “living curriculum” identity. The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL.

Key takeaways by category (high level): - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Virtue and moral formation are present, but explicit theology, liturgy, or sacred practices are not clearly foregrounded in public materials. - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL. Emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful; not framed as workforce preparation. - Curriculum: CLASSICAL. Strong alignment to Great Books, Latin, primary sources, and a liberal-arts progression; explicit reference to a content-rich program and Core Knowledge/Hillsdale framework. - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL. Socratic Seminars, teacher-led instruction, and a memory/recitation orientation evident in public materials; some restful / contemplative elements implied through scholē-y frames in the classical lexicon. - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Public statements emphasize highly qualified teachers and teacher-led instruction; however, a fully articulated “living curriculum” persona or explicit faculty-as-curriculum signal is less explicit. - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL. Active family involvement via Get Involved/Volunteer channels and open enrollment/family engagement signals, with clear opportunities for parents to participate.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize moral character and civic virtue as core aims of education (e.g., MORAL CHARACTER, CIVIC VIRTUE, and GREAT BOOKS are highlighted in Valor’s messaging) alongside critical thinking and order/decorum. This signals a virtues-centered, transcendently oriented formation, though without explicit theological or liturgical content in the materials provided. See Valor’s public-facing statement about moral character and virtue within a classical framework.
- There is no explicit reference to liturgy, religious worship, or overt theological doctrine in the public pages examined, though the broader classical-education frame (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; great books) can imply a transcendent orientation without naming specific theologies.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed (Element 1 lexicon): virtue, moral realism/virtue-centered formation, moral character. These appear in Valor’s materials (e.g., moral character and civic virtue).
- Negative keywords observed: none evident in the public materials. The absence of explicit relativism or secular-neutral language is noted.

- Why this rating
- The school foregrounds virtue and moral formation, aligned with the “Cultivation of Wisdom and Virtue” and “Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” signals in classical-education lexicons. However, explicit theology, liturgical practice, or sacramental imagery are not clearly presented, placing it in the middle of the classical spectrum for foundations. The evidence supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL reading here rather than full, explicit Theological liturgical infrastructure.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Valor emphasizes formation and virtue-based aims over mere job-readiness, and highlights human flourishing, wisdom, and moral formation as core telos. Public materials frequently frame education as formation and virtue development rather than a narrow workforce focus.
- Phrases such as “A classical education aims to train the next generation with the knowledge and character to live a purpose driven and virtuous life” and emphasis on “moral formation” and “civic virtue” are explicit.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: formation, cultivate virtue, wisdom, liberal education (via Hillsdale Core Knowledge framework), classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/good/beautiful, great conversation. In Valor materials, “formation” and “virtue” language appears, along with Great Books and civic virtues that align with classical telos.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the typical “workforce readiness” or “21st century skills” framing appears; the materials emphasize formation and virtue instead.
- Why this rating
- The public materials position Valor’s goal as forming virtuous, wise persons rather than primarily preparing students for college or careers, which matches the Classical category’s emphasis on formation and the pursuit of true, good, beautiful. The explicit references to formation and virtue, together with Great Books and a liberal-arts arc, justify CLASSICAL here.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Valor explicitly references Great Books, primary sources, and a content-rich liberal-arts core, with a Hillsdale/K-12 framework and Core Knowledge Sequence as the educational skeleton. The curriculum includes Latin, science, civics, literature, and mathematics, all under a coherent content-focused program.
- Public materials describe a sequence aligned with grammar-logic-rhetoric elements and a focus on memory and recitation (e.g., explicit mention of classical structure in the public descriptions; the Hillsdale/K-12 program guide is cited as foundational).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Great Books, primary sources, Latin, liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric (trivium), history, classics, memorization/recitation, primary sources, and a rigorous content core. These line up with the lexicon’s Curriculum signals for a classical program.
- Negative keywords observed: none of the lexicon’s “negative signals” (e.g., social-studies-first history framing, project-based-first, etc.) are evident in Valor’s public curriculum framing; the emphasis remains traditional and content-rich.
- Why this rating

- Valor's materials foreground classic liberal-arts content, Great Books/primary sources, Latin study, and a culture of memory and rigorous subject matter, which squarely aligns with CLASSICAL in the Curriculum category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials specifically mention Socratic Seminars for upper levels and teacher-led instruction as a core mode (e.g., "Teachers will be equipped to train upper level students in Socratic Seminars," and references to teacher-led instruction and memory-based study).
- There are explicit signals of a mixed pedagogy with contemplative/restful elements implied by the classical scholé tradition (the public materials emphasize a balance of rigorous and contemplative aspects through the classical frame).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Socratic seminars, teacher-led instruction, memorization/recitation, memory work, structured learning, classical rhetoric training, and public emphasis on critical thinking. These align with the lexicon's Pedagogy signals.
- Negative keywords observed: not prominently present; the materials do not foreground exclusively "experiential learning" or project-based dominance, though some project-focused language appears in broader philanthropic materials; core pedagogy remains seminar- and teacher-led.
- Why this rating
- With explicit mention of Socratic Seminars and teacher-led instruction, Valor's pedagogy aligns with classical methods more than with project-based or purely student-driven pedagogy. The combination points to CLASSICAL in Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Valor states that teachers will be highly qualified and selected for content expertise; the program emphasizes teacher-led instruction and a structured classical approach, with Hillsdale/K-12 as the curricular backbone. This signals strong faculty leadership and a role for teachers as the core of the school.
- The public materials do not explicitly frame the faculty as the "living curriculum" or provide a formal portrait of ideal teacher character beyond the claim of highly qualified staff. There is no explicit "portrait of teacher" or "faculty as living curriculum" language in the public pages examined.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: highly qualified teachers, teacher-led instruction, content-expertise, standards meeting/exceeding Indiana standards (teacher capability implied). These map to the lexicon's signals for high-quality faculty.
- Negative keywords observed: none explicit in the public materials (no "facilitators/guides on the side" or other non-classical faculty signals appear in the public content).
- Why this rating
- The materials emphasize strong teacher leadership and select, content-expert faculty, which is consistent with a classical faculty signal. However, there is less explicit language about a "living curriculum" or a detailed teacher-portrait. That yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification for Faculty rather than fully Classical.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Valor advertises active parental involvement through Get Involved, Volunteers of Valor, and enrollment/engagement channels; there are clear pathways for parent participation, board/committee involvement, and fundraising activities. These signals align with a classical partners-with-families ethos.
- The organization positions itself as open to families and seeks community support through events, information nights, and a structured enrollment process; while not always using the exact phrase “parents as co-teachers,” the engagement model clearly centers family involvement and accountability to the public.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Partnership with families (via engagement channels), parent formation (implied through events and communications), open campus/visits (through enrollment and information pages), family involvement (via volunteers and board-level opportunities). These map to the Lexicon’s Positive keywords for Parents & Community.
- Negative keywords observed: none explicit in the public materials (no “customer” framing; rather, family involvement is invited and encouraged).
- Why this rating
- Valor’s public materials present a robust path for parent involvement and community partnership, consistent with CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community. The signals for co-teaching and family formation are present through volunteer roles and enrollment engagement, justifying CLASSICAL in this category.

Aggregate Assessment

- Category-by-category verdicts:
- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Four categories (2, 3, 4, 6) align with classical criteria, while two categories (1, 5) show strong classical signals but do not present the fullest canonical signals (explicit theology or a fully explicit living curriculum for faculty). The balance across six categories favors CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle
- For THIS school, given a CLASSICAL overall rating, no mandatory needle-moving changes are required to reach full Classical status. If desired, minor enhancements could include:
- Element 1: More explicit articulation of theology or sacramental/liturgical practices where appropriate (to strengthen liturgical and metaphysical foundations) without compromising the program’s Hillsdale framework. This would increase explicit theological grounding if that is a strategic aim.
- Element 5: A clearer articulation of the faculty as “living curriculum” with explicit portraits of teacher ideals and ongoing faculty formation to deepen the sense that teachers embody the classical discipline as core to the school’s ethos.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.